Using Census data on languages, I conservatively estimate the internal diasporas of ten major languages—Hindi, Bengali, Punjabi, Gujarati, Marathi, Odia, Kannada, Telugu, Malayalam and Tamil—that are spoken by over 90 per cent of the Indian population to collectively stand at over 60 million people, more than double the size of India's international diaspora.[60] These are people who have made a significant linguistic crossover. Their descendants who speak Hindi or one of its numerous variants outside the core Hindi heartland in north India and its immediate borders, comprise over 30 million people. This includes the labour diaspora of the Bhojpuris and the mercantile diaspora of the Marwaris concentrated mainly in Gujarat and Maharashtra. Both the diasporas extend towards south India and the North-east. The size of the internal Hindi diaspora is over four times that of what I estimate for the international Hindi diaspora, showing that Hindi or Hindi-variant speaking communities have crossed cultural boundaries within India more often than outside the subcontinent.

This is equally true of those who speak Telugu, Marathi, Bengali (Indian), Kannada, and Odiya. All have moved to major metropolitan centres outside their linguistic zones, as labourers and professionals or due to job transfers in public and private sector enterprises. The Indian Bengalis have spread westwards, but the language appears in large numbers in the Northeast due to the east Bengal, or Bangladeshi, connection. Clusters have also emerged, sometimes following the Great Indian Migration Wave and sometimes outside it. There is thus a Telugu community of over 2,00,000 people in West Bengal, a Marathi-speaking community of over a 1,00,000 in Tamil Nadu and Kerala in the south, and an equally strong Odiya community in Gujarat.

The Gujaratis, as we have seen, have wide-ranging transnational connections, but even they have a larger diaspora within India than outside. The internal Gujarati diaspora is roughly four million strong, in Mumbai and the southern states, and exceeds its international counterpart. It is clearly reflected in the spread of diasporic associations, the lifeblood of community life in India's internal and international linguistic diasporas. There is a Gujarati Samaj in Assam and Tamil Nadu, and there is also one